

THE THONG IN ITSELF

2024

Allow me to present a unique perspective on the nature of awareness and understanding. Despite my extensive research, which involved over ten minutes of typing into a search engine across five distinct queries, I have not found any similar assertion. Therefore, I can confidently state that the idea I am about to introduce is a novel one, never before contemplated by any human mind.

I can feel your anticipation, and I promise to deliver forthwith.

Considering the nature of worldviews and perspectives, one is left to ponder what the absolute truth of anything really is. Philosophers have kicked this conceptual hacky sack around dusty lecture halls for centuries. Immanuel Kant famously dubbed it "The Thing in Itself."

Taking a more serious tone for a moment, the Thing in Itself is a concept born of Kant's philosophy of transcendental idealism. In this model, any given object one encounters in the physical world is merely the outward expression of an undetectable essence. This essence remains hidden because it transcends the narrow frequency band of our five biological senses. We are interacting with the core essence of the thing, but because our biological hardware only processes a tiny sliver of the spectrum, we only detect, and thus appreciate, those limited aspects of its existence.

For example, to basic human eyesight, a chunk of raw plutonium looks like any ordinary grey limestone rock sitting on a gravel road. But place that same rock beside a ticking brass Geiger counter, or slide it under a laboratory spectrometer, and the needles spike. The augmented sensing equipment reveals an energetic furnace that was completely invisible to human eyes.

In principle, if we possessed an infinite workshop packed with specialized sensors capable of measuring every variable in the cosmos, we might finally perceive the Thing in Itself. But that workbench of dials, lenses, and gauges would have to stretch forever down an endless corridor. Therefore, complete objective knowledge of The Thing in Itself is impossible.

That principle is easy enough to accept when applied to physical matter, or even to the cosmos at large. But what happens when we apply it to the other two domains we interact with every single day? Specifically, the Astral and the Devachanic realms, known more commonly as the internal territory of Emotion and the higher realm of Intellect.

By what sensory instrument do we detect the sudden cold spike of fear, or conclude like a gothic poet that the world is a vampire? Do these non-physical realities possess a similar unknowable, absolute essence? This question sits well outside standard textbook epistemology. Yet it is not difficult to postulate the existence of an absolute truth existing independently of our perception, especially when we account for all the distorting lenses that warp our view of non-physical concepts.

Despite operating as separate territories with their own unique laws of being, these realms are deeply interdependent. Our subterranean emotions constantly tint our conscious reasoning, and our deliberate reasoning redirects our emotional tides. Although, for a great many people walking the street, the emotional gut steers the vehicle far more than the intellect.

The physical world also leaves heavy dents in these subtle realms, while our emotions and thoughts can only touch physical matter through the narrow mechanical leverage of the biological bodies we inhabit. This physical bottleneck suggests that the material world is not our native home, but a

rugged frontier outpost, satisfying the concept of a clear directional gradient between the subtle realms and the concrete.

With that architecture established, a strong case can be made that the concept of the Thing in Itself applies directly to higher realms. That being the case, we must accept the subsequent postulate: the absolute essence of an emotion or an idea is inherently unknowable. However, an explorer can still steer their vessel closer to the target. How does one accomplish that?

Our perception of higher truths is constantly obscured by heavy distortions: personal prejudices, thick smudges of cognitive bias, warped mirrors of anecdotal assumptions, and self-limiting beliefs. Therefore, the key to seeing reality as it truly exists does not require building new eyes, but systematically scrubbing away the grime that clouds the windowpane.

Even the most intrepid explorer with a clean pane of glass will never perceive these realms with absolute perfection. If we plot this dynamic on a coordinate grid, charting the clarity of our perception on the vertical axis against the removal of internal mental fog on the horizontal axis, the curve tells the story. The plotted line sweeps upward in a classic mathematical asymptote, climbing toward the ceiling of absolute truth. It draws infinitely close, skimming just below the line of the Thing in Itself, but by the strict laws of geometry, it never touches the target.

Given these geometric limits, what does it actually mean when someone claims to see the world as it truly is, or boasts that they can see right through their own biases? Taken literally, the claim is always false. But that standard is no fun, and nobody is going to buy into absolute futility. Therefore, we must establish a certified margin of error for reality perception that is functional enough to warrant a special designation.

Because no philosopher or academic institution before this moment has ever formulated an answer to this question, I hereby establish the standard. The acceptable margin of error for reality perception to be certified accurate is officially: **TEN PERCENT (10%)**.